



**UGANDA MANUFACTURERS ASSOCIATION
AUTOMOTIVE SECTOR MEETING
6th AUGUST 2025, 10:00 AM
UMA UPPER BOARDROOM
MINUTES**

AGENDA.

1. Opening prayer
2. Self introduction
3. Communication from the chair.
4. Overview of the automotive sector and challenges (Discussion on the issue of number plates)
5. Way forward, strategies and proposals for sector improvement.
6. Conclusion.

MEMBERS PRESENT

No.	NAME	ORGANISATION	DESIGNATION	CONTACT
1.	Manish Gupta	YUVRAJ International co. ltd	Head Finance	headfinance@yuvrajinternational.com
2.	Senyonga John Musoke	Arnold Brooklyn co ltd	Manager	0772456408
3.	Kobe Xiao	Double Q Co. ltd	V.P	xiaohaokone@doubleq.co.ug 0772599936
4.	Stanislas P	Tata Uganda Ltd	Sales Head	Stanislaus.Ruih@tatainternational.com 0740000098
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6.	Charles Oyoro	Motorcare Uganda ltd	logistics	c.oyoro@ug.motocare



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7.	William Byamugisha	MTIC	Engineer	williambyamugisha@mtic.go.ug 0785587851
8.	Kawalya Douglas	MAC EA LTD	Asst. Sales Manager	Aditya-Arora@macuganda.com 0700414666
9.	Kugonza Davis	ZHEN XI	Manager	0779069418
10.	Busingye David	Spear group	Director Assistant	busingyed@wawahwater.co.ug
11.	Gilbert Wavamunno	Spear motors ltd	M.D	gilbertw@spearmotors.co.ug 0772707171
12.	Richard Musani	Double Q	Head of marketing	richardmusani@doubleq.co.ug 0782436021
13.	Semeo Ssentamu	Dura motors ltd	Sales and marketing	Ssentamu20012@gmail.com 0705818983
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15.	Busingye Deon	Dura motors limited	operations	deonbusingye@gmail.com 0705111022
16.	Jiampeng Zhang	Dura motors Ltd	M.D	0752809894
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18.	Allan Ssenyondwa	UMA	DPRA-UMA	directorpolicy@uma.or.ug 0784358654
19.	Kahwa Epafra	LEXSON	Operations.	
20.	Deudatha Chitale	Tata Uganda LTD	AUTO HEAD	deudatha.chitale@tatainternational.com 0757744380
21.	Brian Asimwe	CFAO Mobility Uganda	Toyota sales manager	basiimwe@cfao.com 0752731752
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23.	Otti David	Victoria Motors Ltd	General manager	d.otti@gmach.ug



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24.	Labeja Akengo	SKENYA MOTORS LTD	Sales manager	labeja@skenya.com 0752500182
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26.	Birungi Mary Gladys	Spear motors Ltd	Sales representative	gladysbirungi@gmail.com 0706714453
27.	Akugizibwe Deogratias	UMA	Graduate trainee(coordinator automotive sector)	deoa356@gmail.com 0774126361

MINUTES.

MINUTE	DELIBERATION	WAY FORWARD	RESPONSIBILITY
Minute 1: Opening Prayer	The meeting was opened with a prayer led by Mustafa Tazanya, thanking God for the opportunity to convene and seek solutions to sector challenges.		Tazanya Mustafa
Minute 2: Self introduction	All attendees introduced themselves, stating their names, organizations, and roles to foster mutual understanding and establish an open forum for discussion.		All Attendees
Minute 3: Communication from the chair.	Mr. Manish Gupta provided a comprehensive background on the number plate issue affecting the automotive sector. He outlined prior commitments made by the Ministry of Works and Transport regarding number plate system improvements and highlighted how these promises have largely not been met. He emphasized that delayed delivery of number plates and complex system implementations have	Intensify stakeholder engagement with government ministries to ensure fulfillment of promises Raise sector awareness on economic impacts	Mr. Manish Gupta



	caused significant financial losses through reduced sales across the sector. He strongly warned that if corrective actions are not taken urgently, the automotive industry risks collapse. He called for collective responsibility and government accountability to resolve ongoing bottlenecks.	Advocate for swift and transparent action plans to avoid industry collapse	
Minute 4: Overview of the Automotive Sector and Challenge	Director Allan elaborated on the challenges surrounding the number plate system. He clarified that the vehicle tracking system is distinct from the physical number plates. Allan expressed concerns about the disparity between what was promised by authorities and what the sector has actually received. Key issues raised included: miscommunication between URA and Ministry of Transport affecting log book issuance; the fact that number plates are locally produced while the tracking technology is imported from China; and questions about the country's capacity to manufacture all car components, including plates. Furthermore, Allan questioned whether current challenges are limiting automobile release into the market Mr. Gilbert Wavamuno highlighted that prior to the digital plate system, number plates were imported with superior quality materials. He regretted that the new plates are made from inferior aluminium, reducing durability and perceived value. Despite initial claims that the new system would reduce crime, evidence shows little impact.	Advocate for clearer communication and coordination between URA and Ministry of Transport. Explore enhancing local manufacturing capabilities. Address logistical inefficiencies affecting automobile market availability.	All members present.



	Members questioned the justification for the additional 700,000 UGX fee and suggested that the tracking component could have been integrated into the existing plate system, avoiding disruption to local manufacturers. They stressed that the new plates are fundamentally similar to the old ones but equipped with a tracking device, disadvantaging local producers Mr. Richard Musani conveyed concerns specific to the two-wheeler's association, noting lack of security clarity and accountability. Despite meetings with the minister targeting a turnaround by 15th July, no progress was evident. Mr. Douglas from Isuzu remarked on the complexity and confusion introduced by the system, questioning if improvements were genuine or if the system was simply more bureaucratic, with no agency taking responsibility. Mr. William from the Ministry of Trade explained government tendencies to respond better to organized sector bodies rather than individual companies, encouraging unity in advocacy efforts. He acknowledged the discrepancies in nomenclature, size, colour, and technical standards of number plates, highlighted the camera system capabilities for old plates, and called for better stakeholder collaboration.	Lobby for reconsideration of the additional fee; support retention of local manufacturers by integrating tracking into existing plate designs; conduct independent quality assessments of current plates; raise awareness in the sector about true system features versus claims.	
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	The meeting discussed key emerging concerns: • The Buy Uganda Build Uganda (BUBU) initiative was perceived as neglected in system procurement and implementation. • Privacy concerns relating to national security versus individual rights, with fears about data misuse especially on tracking devices. • Poor quality of service delivery, including inadequate connectivity and accessibility to the company managing the new plates. • Lack of transparency and accountability by the new company, cited as monopolistic and incompetent. • Difficulties accessing premises where funds are managed, leading to sector suspicion and mistrust.	Encourage unity and collective representation of the sector in government engagements; improve transparency and define agency responsibilities; harmonize technical standards and nomenclature; enhance public education on system operation and capabilities; promote multi-stakeholder dialogue forums.	
Minute 5: Way Forward: Strategies and Proposals for Sector Improvement	Members proposed the following key actions. • Harmonization meetings to address challenges in the tricycle and wider automotive sector. • Integration of logbooks and number plate systems for immediate synchronization, which has not yet been fully realized, undermining system effectiveness. • Synchronization of number plates with URA's manual entry system is critical since the current digital software is not integrated. • Strongly worded communication from the sector to government to highlight all	Call for transparent audits and public reporting on company performance; engage government on respecting BUBU guidelines; balance privacy and security needs through policy reviews; demand improved service delivery standards and open communication channels from managing entities.	All present.



	outstanding issues and request formal dialogue sessions. • Copy insurance companies in communications for sector-wide awareness and cooperation. • Proposal to retrofit tracking devices onto existing number plates, allowing local manufacturers to remain operational. • Establishment of a dedicated call center to guide where stakeholders can report issues and seek assistance. • Suggestion to prioritize the discussion of taxes on spare parts at the next meeting. • Organize and conduct harmonization meetings to advance system integration and sector collaboration. • Draft and send comprehensive issue reports and requests for government dialogue. • Advocate for adding tracking devices to existing plates to preserve local industry livelihoods. • Develop a stakeholder service call centre for improved communication channels. • Schedule the next meeting agenda to cover taxation on spare parts		
Minute 6: Closure	The meeting was formally adjourned with a closing remark emphasizing the need for urgent collaborative action to prevent further deterioration of the automotive sector.		All present